



— Academy

Ratio Study

QUALITY

ADVANCED

Measure whether your roll is accurate AND uniform — and read what it’s telling you.

THE PROBLEM

What you’re facing

You need to know whether assessed values track the market (level) and whether they treat similar properties consistently (uniformity) — before the state does its own study.

WHY IT MATTERS

What’s at stake

The ratio study is how the roll is graded. A median ratio outside 0.90–1.10 signals level problems; a high COD signals inequity; PRD/PRB drift signals regressivity (over-assessing modest homes relative to expensive ones). These findings drive reappraisal decisions and state oversight.

THE MENTAL MODEL

How experts think

Experts read the three numbers together, not in isolation: median (level), COD (uniformity), and PRD/PRB (vertical equity). A 1.00 median with a COD of 25 is NOT a good roll — it’s accurate on average and unfair in detail. They segment by neighborhood and price tier because a healthy county-wide number can hide a broken corridor.

Workflow

1. Assemble qualified sales for the study period and compute assessment-to-sale ratios.
2. Compute median ratio (level), COD (uniformity), and PRD/PRB (vertical equity).
3. Compare against IAAO standards: COD ≤ ~15 for residential improved; PRD ~0.98–1.03; PRB ~±0.05.
4. Segment by neighborhood and price decile to locate where the problem actually lives.
5. Decide: hold, targeted reappraisal, or full reval for the affected stratum.

Common mistakes

- Celebrating a 1.00 median while ignoring a high COD.
- Letting unqualified sales contaminate the sample.
- Studying only the county-wide aggregate and missing a broken neighborhood.
- Treating PRD/PRB as academic instead of an equity (and legal) signal.

Tools

Qualified sales file Ratio study template (WA DOR / Dornfest) IAAO Standard on Mass Appraisal Neighborhood + price strata

DO THIS NEXT

Now What?

- 1 Run the study segmented by neighborhood and price decile, not just county-wide.
- 2 Triage the worst-COD strata for targeted reappraisal first.
- 3 Document the level/

